



MODAL VERBS



ABILITY

Can (present ability).
Could (past ability).
Will be able to (future ability).

ADVICE

Should and **ought to** to recommend something.



OBLIGATION

Must (it expresses an obligation imposed by the speaker) and **have to/has to** (it expresses an external obligation for the speaker).



In negative, the meaning is different:
Mustn't: it means prohibition.
Don't/doesn't have to: it means lack of obligation.



DEDUCTION

Must (it is used when we feel sure that something is true) or **can't** (it is used when we feel sure that something is not possible).



PROBABILITY

May and **might** are used for this use.
Might is less probable.



PERMISSION

Could or **may** (this form is more polite and formal).



OFFER AND REQUEST

Can, **may** and **could** (these last two are more formal).

